

2. STATEMENT — ARGUMENTS

In this type of questions, a statement concerned with a political, social or economic issue is given, followed by two arguments, generally one in favour of and one against the statement. The candidate is required to analyse first the statement, then the arguments in context of the statement and decide which of the arguments holds strong, and helps, formulate the most appropriate opinion on the subject.

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLES

Directions : Each of the following questions consists of a statement followed by two arguments I and II.

Give answer (a) if only argument I is strong; (b) if only argument II is strong; (c) if either I or II is strong; (d) if neither I nor II is strong and (e) if both I and II are strong.

Ex. 1. Statement : Should number of holidays of government employees be reduced ?

Arguments : I. Yes. Our government employees are having maximum number of holidays among the other countries of the world.

II. Yes. It will lead to increased productivity of government offices.

(Bank P.O. 1998)

Sol. Clearly, a comparison with the system in other countries is no strong a criteria for taking a decision on the issue. So, argument I does not hold. Also, reducing the number of holidays implies more working hours which will surely increase productivity.

Hence, the answer is (6).

Ex. 2. Statement : Should foreign films be banned in India ?

Arguments : I. Yes. They depict an alien culture which adversely affects our values.

II. No. Foreign films are of a high artistic standard.

Sol. Clearly foreign films depict the alien culture but this only helps in learning more. So, argument I does not hold. Also, the reason stated in argument II is not strong enough in contradicting the ban. So, it also does not hold.

Thus, the answer is (rf).

Ex. 3. Statement : Should there be reservation of seats and posts on communal basis ?

(M.A/T. 1997)

Arguments : 1. Yes. It will check most of the inter-communal biases. ;

II. No. Ours is a secular state.

Sol. Clearly, reservations on communal basis will increase inter communal biases. So, argument I is vague. Also, it will be against the secular policy, according to which no communal group is given preference over the others. So, only argument II holds.

Hence, the answer is (6).

Ex. 4. Statement : Should young entrepreneurs be encouraged ?

Arguments : I. Yes. They will help in industrial development of the country.
II. Yes. They will reduce the burden on employment market.

Sol. Clearly, encouraging the young entrepreneurs will open up the field for the establishment of new industries. Thus, it shall help in industrial development and not only employ the entrepreneurs but create more job opportunities for others as well. So, both the arguments hold strong.
Hence, the answer is (e).

Ex. 5. Statement : Should government stop spending huge amounts of money on international sports ? **(Bank P.O. 1996)**

Arguments : I. Yes. This money can be utilised for upliftment of the poor.
II. No. Sportspersons will be frustrated and will not get international exposure.

Sol. Clearly, spending money on sports cannot be avoided merely because it can be spent on socio-economic problems. So, argument I does not hold. Also if the expenses on sports are curtailed, the sportspersons would face lack of facilities and training and our country will lag behind in international sports competitions.
Hence, the answer is (b). ^

Ex. 6. Statement : Should octroi be abolished ?

Arguments 2 I. Yes. It will eliminate an important source of corruption.
II. No. It will adversely affect government revenues.

Sol. 'Octroi' is a custom duty. If octroi is abolished, the practice of bringing in things from foreign countries illegally will be abolished. So, argument I holds strong. If octroi is abolished, the income to the government in the way of the duty paid shall be diminished. So, argument II also holds strong.
Hence, the answer is (e).

Ex. 7. Statement : Should taxes on colour television be further increased ?

Arguments : I. Yes. Colour television is a luxury item and only rich people buy them.
II. No. Televisions are bought by the poor too.

Sol. Clearly, taxes on an item cannot be increased or decreased on the basis of the financial position of the people who buy it. So, both arguments 1 and II do not hold strong.
Hence, the answer is (d).

Ex. 8. Statement : Should English be the medium of instruction for higher education in India ?

Arguments : I. Yes. Even in advanced countries like England and U.S.A., the medium of instruction is English for higher education.
II. Yes. English is a much widely spoken language in the world.

Sol. Clearly, the pursuance of a policy in India cannot be based on the pretext that it is followed in other advanced countries because every country has its own environment, situations and resources. So, argument I is vague. Clearly, English needs to be pursued in higher education because being widely spoken it shall ensure uniformity and prepare the students better. So, argument II holds.
Hence, the answer is (6).

EXERCISE 2A

Directions : Each question given below consists of a statement, followed by two arguments I and II. You have to decide which of the arguments is a 'strong' argument and which is a 'weak' argument.

Give answer (a) if only argument I is strong; (b) if only argument II is strong; (c) if either I or II is strong; (d) if neither I nor II is strong and (e) if both I and II are strong.

1. **Statement** Should there be a ban on product advertising ?
Arguments I. No. It is an age of advertising. Unless your advertisement is better than your other competitors, the product will not be sold.
 II. Yes. The money spent on advertising is very huge and it inflates the cost of the product. (S.B.I.P.O. 1995)
2. **Statement** Should a total ban be put on trapping wild animals ?
Arguments I. Yes. Trappers are making a lot of money.
 II. No. Bans on hunting and trapping are not effective.
3. **Statement** Should telecasting feature films be stopped ?
Arguments I. Yes. Young children are misguided by the feature films.
 II. No. This is the only way to educate the masses.
4. **Statement** Should school education be made free in India ? (S.B.I.P.O. 1997)
Arguments I. Yes. This is the only way to improve the level of literacy.
 II. No. It would add to the already heavy burden on the exchequer.
5. **Statement** Is paying ransom or agreeing to the conditions of kidnappers of political figures, a proper course of action ?
Arguments I. Yes. The victims must be saved at all cost.
 II. No. It encourages the kidnappers to continue their sinister activities.
6. **Statement** Should government jobs in rural areas have more incentives ?
Arguments I. Yes. Incentives are essential for attracting government servants there.
 II. No. Rural areas are already cheaper, healthier and less complex than big. So, why offer extra incentives !
7. **Statement** Should India stop missile development ?
Arguments I. Yes. The U.S.A. desires so.
 II. No. The nation must always remain up-to-date in its defence preparedness.
8. **Statement** Should we scrap the 'Public Distribution System' in India ?
Arguments I. Yes. Protectivism is over, everyone must get the bread on his/her own.
 II. Yes. The poor do not get any benefit because of corruption. (Bank P.O. 1998)
9. **Statement** Should India go in for computerisation in industry ?
Arguments I. No. Computerisation demands a lot of money. We should not waste money on it.
 II. Yes. When advanced countries are introducing computers in India, how can India afford to lag behind ?

Hidden page

Hidden page

Hidden page

Voltage across R_s $V_s = I_D R_s$

Since gate current is negligibly small, the gate terminal is at d.c. ground i.e., $V_g = 0$.

$$V_{GS} = V_G - V_S = 0 - I_D R_s$$

Thus, bias voltage V_{GS} keeps gate negative w.r.t. source.

Operating point. The d.c. operating point (i.e., zero signal I_D and V_{DS}) can be easily determined. Since the parameters of JFET are usually known, zero signal I_D can be calculated from the following relation :

$$I_D = \frac{K}{2} (V_{GS} - V_{P0})^2$$

Also V_{DS}

Thus, d.c. conditions of JFET amplifier are fully specified.

(ii) Potential divider method. Fig. 32.20 shows potential divider method of biasing a JFET. This circuit is identical to that used for a transistor. The resistors R_1 and R_2 form a voltage divider across drain supply V_{DD} . The voltage V_2 across R_2 provides the necessary bias.

SIGNAL IN

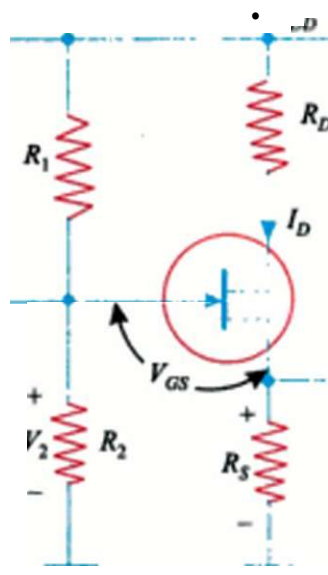


Fig. 32.20

Now $V_{GS} = \frac{R_2}{R_1 + R_2} V_{DD} - I_D R_s$

The circuit is so designed that $I_D R_s$ is larger than V_{GS} , so that V_{GS} is negative. This provides correct bias voltage. We can find the operating point as under:

$$V_{GS} = V_{GS} - I_D R_s$$

and

32.16. JFET CONNECTIONS

There are three leads in a JFET viz., source, gate and drain terminals. However, when a JFET is to be connected in a circuit, we require four terminals; two for the input and two for output. This difficulty is overcome by making one terminal of the JFET common to both input and output terminals. Accordingly, a JFET can be connected in a circuit in the following three ways :

- (i) Common source connection
- (ii) Common gate connection
- (iii) Common drain connection

The common source connection is the most widely used arrangement. It is because this connection provides high input impedance, good voltage gain and a moderate output impedance. However, the circuit pro-

+K_v

Output

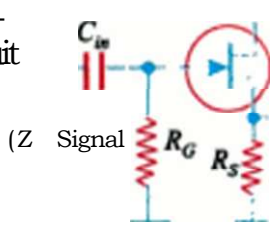


Fig. 32.21

32. Statement : Should India manufacture atom bombs ?
 Arguments : I. Yes. It is imperative to protect the sovereignty and integrity of the country.
 II. No. This will create imbalance in the power of nations in this region.
33. Statement : Should computers be used in all possible sectors in India ?
 Arguments : I. Yes. It will bring efficiency and accuracy in the work.
 II. No. It will be an injustice to the monumental human resources which are at present underutilised.
34. Statement : Should family planning be made compulsory in India ?
 Arguments : I. Yes. Looking to the miserable conditions in India, there is no other go.
 II. No. In India there are people of various religions and family planning is against the tenets of some of the religions.
- (Hotel Management, 1992)**
35. Statement : Should films be included in the Concurrent List ?
 Arguments : I. Yes. It will give respect to the views of the states.
 II. No. It will deteriorate the standard of films,
36. Statement : Should there be only one university throughout India ?
 Arguments : I. Yes. This is the only way to bring about uniformity in the educational standards.
 II. No. This is administratively impossible.
37. Statement : Should there be a world government ? **(M.B.A. 1996)**
 Arguments : I. Yes. It will help in eliminating tensions among the nations.
 II. No. Then, only the developed countries will dominate in the government.
38. Statement : Should workers be allowed to participate in the management of factories in India ?
 Arguments : I. Yes. It is the present management theory.
 II. No. Many workers are illiterate and so their contributions will not be of any value.
39. Statement : Are educational institutions responsible for unrest among the youth ?
 Arguments : I. Yes. There is no discipline in educational institutions.
 II. No. There are no disciplinary problems in educational institutions.
40. Statement : Should the political parties be banned ?
 Arguments : I. Yes. It is necessary to teach a lesson to the politicians.
 II. No. It will lead to an end of democracy.
41. Statement : Should jobs be linked with academic degrees and diplomas ?
 Arguments : I. No. A very large number of persons with meagre academic qualifications will apply.
 II. No. Importance of higher education will be diminished,
42. Statement : Should we scrap the system of formal education beyond graduation ?

- Arguments** I. Yes. It will mean taking employment at an early date.
II. No. It will mean lack of depth of knowledge (M.B.A. 1997)
- 43. Statement** Is Governorship better than Chief Ministership ?
Argument* I. Yes. It is the highest post in a state.
II. No. The Chief Minister commands more power.
- 44. Statement** Should all news be controlled by Government in a democracy ?
Arguments I. Yes. Variety of news only confuses people.
II. No. Controlled news loses credibility.
- 45. Statement** Should there be no place of interview in selection ?
Arguments I. Yes. It is very subjective in assessment.
II. No. It is the only instrument to judge candidates' motives and personality.
- 46. Statement** Should higher education be completely stopped for sometime ?
Arguments I. No. It will hamper the country's future progress.
II. Yes. It will reduce the educated unemployment.
- 47. Statement** Should mercy death be legalized ?
Arguments I. Yes. Patients undergoing terrible suffering and having absolutely no chance of recovery should be liberated from suffering through mercy death.
II. No. Even mercy death is a sort of killing and killing can never be legalized.
- 48. Statement** Should the institution of marriages be abolished ?
Arguments I. Yes. It is already showing cracks.
II. No. It is necessary for the survival of the society.
- 49. Statement** Should non-vegetarian food be totally banned in our country ?
Arguments I. Yes. It is expensive and therefore it is beyond the means of most people in our country.
II. No. Nothing should be banned in a democratic country like ours.
- 50. Statement** Should election expenses to Central and State Legislatures be met by the government ?
Arguments I. Yes. It will put an end to political corruption.
II. No. It is not good in any country'.

ANSWERS

1. ie): Clearly, it is the advertisement which makes the customer aware of the qualities of the product and leads him to buy it. So, argument I is valid But at the same time.

: ** * ch ~ k most of the inter-communal biases'
No Ours is a secular state.

Hence, the answer is (b).

Hidden page

Hidden page

Hidden page

Hidden page

- Arguments** I. Yes. Most of the energy sources used at present are exhaustible.
II. No. Harnessing solar energy requires a lot of capital, which India lacks in.
- 11. Statement** Should public holidays be declared on demise of important national leaders ?
(&B.I.P.O.1995)
- Arguments** I. No. Such unscheduled holidays hamper national progress.
II. Yes. People would like to pay their homage to the departed soul.
- 12. Statement** Should cutting of trees be banned altogether ?
- Arguments** I. Yes. It is very much necessary to do so to restore ecological balance.
II. No. A total ban would harm timber based industries.
- 13. Statement** Is the Government justified in spending so much on defence ?
- Arguments** I. Yes. Safety of the country is of prime importance.
II. No. During peace, this money could be used for the development of the country.
- 14. Statement** Should judiciary be independent of the executive ?
- Arguments** I. Yes. This would help curb the unlawful activities of the executive.
II. No. The executive would not be able to take bold measures.
- 15. Statement** Should so much money be spent on advertisements ?
- Arguments** I. Yes. It is an essential concomitant in a capitalist economy.
II. No. It leads to wastage of resources.
- 16. Statement** Should all the transport corporations be handed over to the private organisations ?
- Arguments** I. Yes. There will be a significant change in the quality and punctuality of services.
II. No. There would not be job security for the employees at all the levels.
(Bank P.O. 1998)
- 17. Statement** Should loyalty be the only criterion for promotion in any organisation ?
- Arguments** I. Yes. Without loyal men, no organisation can function.
II. No. It leads to hypocrisy and partiality.
- 18. Statement** Should untouchability be banned in India ?
- Arguments** I. No. Menial people deteriorate the living standard of society.
II. Yes. All people should be equally treated in a democratic country like India.
- 19. Statement** Should there be a complete ban on manufacture of firecrackers in India ?
(SJB.I.P.O. 1997)
- Arguments** I. No. This will render thousands of workers jobless.
II. Yes. The firecracker manufacturers use child labour to a large extent.
- 20. Statement** Is caste based reservation policy justified ?
- Arguments** I. Yes. The step is a must to bring the underprivileged at par with the privileged ones.
II. No. It obstructs the establishment of a classless society.

Hidden page

32. Statement Arguments

Should the government levy tax on agricultural income also ?
I. Yes. That is the only way to fill government coffers.
II. No. Eighty percent of our population live in rural areas.
(S.B.IJP.O. 1995)
33. Statement Arguments

Should coal engines be replaced by electric engines in trains ?
I. Yes. Coal engines cause a lot of pollution.
II. No. India does not produce enough electricity to fulfil its domestic needs also.
34. Statement Arguments

Should women be provided more job opportunities ?
I. No. They are entrusted with household jobs.
II. Yes. They should also go into the outside world.
35. Statement Arguments

Should personal tax be abolished in India ?
I. Yes. It will motivate people to earn more.
II. No. Individuals must learn to share their wealth with other people.
36. Statement Arguments

Should judicial activism be discouraged ? (Bank P.O. 1998)
I. No. If we leave everything in the hands of executive, justice may be a distant dream.
II. Yes. Judiciary should mind its own business. Executive will take its own course.
37. Statement Arguments

Should officers accepting bribe be punished ?
1. No. Certain circumstances may have compelled them to take bribe.
II. Yes. They should do the job they are entrusted with, honestly.
38. Statement Arguments

Are nuclear families better than joint families ?
I. No. Joint families ensure security and also reduce the burden of work.
II. Yes. Nuclear families ensure greater freedom
- 39 Statement Arguments

Should India give away Kashmir to Pakistan ?
I. No. Kashmir is a beautiful state. It earns a lot of foreign exchange for India.
II. Yes. This would help settle conflicts.
40. Statement Arguments

Should India have no military force at all ?
I. No. Other countries in the world do not believe in non-violence.
II. Yes. Many Indians believe in non-violence.
41. Statement Arguments

Should students' union in universities be abolished ?
I. Yes. Students can pay full attention to their career development
IT. No. All the great leaders had been students' union leaders.
(Bank P.O. 1996)
42. Statement Arguments

Should higher education be reserved for deserving few ?
I. No. It will increase unemployment.
II. Yes. It will minimise wastage in higher education.

/

- 43. Statement** Should those who receive dowry, despite the law prohibiting it, be punished ?
Arguments I. Yes. Those who violate the law, must be punished.
 II. No. Dowry system is firmly rooted in the society since time immemorial.
- 44. Statement** Should all refugees, who make unauthorised entry into a country, be forced to go back to their homeland ?
Arguments I. Yes. They make their colonies and occupy a lot of land.
 II. No. They leave their homes because of hunger or some terror and on human grounds, should not be forced to go back.
- 45. Statement** Should the system of Lok Adalats and mobile courts be encouraged in India ?
Arguments I. Yes. It helps to grant speedy justice to the masses.
 II. No. These courts are usually partial in granting justice.
- 46. Statement** Should the tuition fees in all post-graduate courses be hiked considerably ? (SBJLP.O. 1997)
Arguments I. Yes. This will bring in some sense of seriousness among the students and will improve the quality.
 II. No. This will force the meritorious poor students to stay away from post-graduate courses.
- 47. Statement** Should smoking be prohibited ?
Arguments I. Yes. It is wrong to smoke away millions of money.
 II. No. It will throw thousands of workers in the tobacco industry out of employment.
- 48. Statement** Should selection tests be of the objective rather than of the descriptive type ?
Arguments I. Yes. The assessment of answers to objective type questions is fair and impartial.
 II. No. The descriptive type test is certainly a better tool than the objective type test.
- 49. Statement** Should education be made compulsory for all children upto the age of 14 ? (M.A.T. 1997)
Arguments I. Yes. This will help to eradicate the system of forced employment of these children.
 II. Yes. This would increase the standard of living.
- 50. Statement** Should religion be taught in our schools ?
Arguments I. No. Ours is a secular state.
 II. Yes. Teaching religion helps inculcate moral values among children.

ANSWERS

1. (a): Clearly, health care services must be looked after by the Government and opening well-equipped hospitals in every area would surely provide better health services to the citizens. So, argument 1 is valid. Also, it is not an impractical task and can be achieved by the Government. So, argument II is vague.
2. (c): Clearly, inducement in politics trains the students for future leadership but it keeps them from the studies. So, either of the arguments I or II can hold

3. (o): [-earning martial arts is necessary for girls for self-defence. So. argument I holds. However, argument II is vague since a training in these arts has nothing to do with their feminine grace.
4. (6): Clearly, the first argument is not a strong reason in support of the statement. Also. it is not possible to analyse the really deserving and not deserving. So, argument II holds strong.
5. (c) : Religion binds people together through the name of God and human values. But it may also develop fanaticism and ill-will among people. So, both the arguments hold strong.
6. (6): Clearly, the pursuance of a policy in India cannot be based on the pretext that it is followed in other countries because every country has its own environment and situations. So, argument I is vague. But increasing the age of retirement is indeed a genuine demand of most of the employees to be self-dependent throughout. So. argument II holds.
7. (a): Clearly, shifting agriculture is a practice in which a certain crop is grown on a land and when it becomes infertile it is left bare and another piece of land is chosen. Clearly, it is a wasteful practice. So, only argument I holds.
8. (a): Before indulging in new development programme it is much necessary to plan the exact target, policies and their implementation and the allocation of funds which shows the right direction to work. So, argument I holds strong. Also, planning ensures full utilisation of available resources and funds and a stepwise approach towards the target So, spending a part of money on it is no wastage. Thus, argument II is not valid.
9. (a) : Clearly. India can export only the surplus and those which can be saved from the luxury needs to pay for its import. Encouragement to export cannot lead to shortages as it shall provide the resources for imports. So, only argument I holds.
10. (a): Clearly, harnessing solar energy will be helpful as it is an inexhaustible resource unlike other resources. So, argument I holds. But argument II is vague as solar energy is the cheapest form of energy.
11. (a) : Clearly, unscheduled and untimely holidays would naturally cause the work to suffer. So. argument I holds strong. Also, a holiday is not necessary to pay homage to someone. So. argument II is vague.
12. (ie) ; Clearly, trees play a vital role in maintaining ecological balance and so must be preserved. So. argument I holds. Also, trees form the basic source of timber and a complete ban on cutting of trees would harm timber based industries. So, only a controlled cutting of trees should be allowed and the loss replenished by planting more trees. So, argument II is also valid.
13. (a): Clearly, defence is necessary for the safety of the country, which is of prime importance. So. argument I holds Also, a country can concentrate on internal progress and development only when it is safe from external aggressions So, argument II is not valid.
14. (a) : Clearly, independent judiciary is necessary for impartial judgement so that the Executive does not take wrong measures. So. only argument I holds.
15. (a): Clearly, the advertisements are the means to introduce people with the product and its advantages. So. argument I holds strong But argument II is vague because advertisements are an investment for better gain and not a wastage.
16. (*) : Since both the arguments contain a strong reason in explanation of the statement, so both I and II hold.
17. (d): Clearly, the argument in support of the statement is quite vague. Also, when loyalty is considered, hypocrisy does not matter much as the fact that efficiency is neglected So. the arguments are not strong enough.
18. (6): Clearly, there is no question of 'menial' when all the persons are born equal. So, only argument II holds.

Hidden page

exercise its influence over the other and prevent its malfunctioning. So, both I and II do not hold strong.

37. (6): Clearly, officers are paid duly for the jobs they do. So, they must do it honestly. Thus, argument II alone holds.
- 3d. (<?): Clearly, with so many people around in a joint family, there is more security. Also, work is shared. So, argument I holds. In nuclear families, there are lesser number of people and so lesser responsibilities and more freedom.
39. (a): Clearly, India cannot part with its state that is a major foreign exchange earner to it So, argument I holds strong. Further, giving away a piece of land unconditionally and unreasonably is no solution to settle disputes. So, argument II is vague.
40. *id*) : Clearly, India needs to have military force to defend itself against the threat of other military powers in the world. So, both the arguments do not hold strong.
41. (a): Clearly, abolishing students' union would relieve the students of the unnecessary activities and enable them to concentrate well on studies. So, argument I holds. However, it is not that participation in students' unions only can make one a great leader. So, argument II is vague
42. (b): Clearly, higher education in no way reduces unemployment. So, argument I is vague. If higher education is imparted to only those who are worth it, the wasteful expenditures on undeserving shall be reduced. So, argument II also holds.
43. (a): Clearly, laws are made to ensure that no person pursues the practice. So, persons who violate the laws need to be punished. Thus, argument I holds. A wrong practice, no matter how firmly rooted, needs to be ended. So, argument II is vague.
44. (6): Clearly, refugees are people forced out of their homeland by some misery and need shelter desperately So, argument II holds Argument 1 against the statement, is vague.
45. (a): Courts are meant to judge impartially. So, argument II is vague. The system of local courts shall speed up the justice So, argument I holds.
46. (6) : A hike in fees is no means to make the students more serious in studies. So, argument I is vague. However, with the increase in fees, poor meritorious students would not be able to afford post-graduate studies. So, argument II holds.
47. (rf): Clearly, smoking needs to be abolished because it is injurious* to health and not only to save money. So, argument I is vague. Clearly, to provide employment one cannot continue a hazardous task. So, argument II is also vague.
48. (a): Clearly, judgement in subjective tests depends upon the individual who judges while that in objective tests is fair and impartial So, argument I alone holds and argument II is vague.
49. <d) : Clearly, education is necessary to make the children better citizens. So, none of the arguments is strong enough.
50. (6) : Ours is a secular state does not mean that religion and religious values should be eradicated. In fact, these inculcate moral values. So, argument I is vague and only argument II is strong.